

and also a lively scherzo, in this edition arranged for piano.

A star of the podium

In addition to gaining a reputation as a composer and pianist, Mendelssohn also quickly made a mark as a conductor; this specialist role was still new and Mendelssohn became one of the first real “stars” of the podium. Most notably, in 1829, aged 20, he organized and conducted the first performance of Bach’s St. Matthew Passion since the composer’s death, thus inaugurating a major revival of interest in Bach’s music.

“There is **one god—Bach—and Mendelssohn**
is his **prophet.**”

HECTOR BERLIOZ

Travels and meetings

Soon after this triumph, Mendelssohn embarked on his first independent journey abroad, to England. He later made nine more visits to the country, where he felt at home (he spoke the language fluently) and was much acclaimed. During this first stay, which lasted from April to November 1829, he also spent a week in Wales and made a more extensive tour of Scotland, his sightseeing including a boat trip to the uninhabited island of Staffa in the Inner Hebrides. This inspired him to write his overture The Hebrides, also known—from the most